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Beyond this Module

As a junior penetration tester or sysadmin, one could expect the tasks in this module to be everyday tasks for you to take action on. Sometimes under direct guidance and supervision, sometimes not. A deep understanding of Windows, its CLI, and what we can glean from it (access and enumeration-wise) is essential to fulfilling the role's duties. By the end of the skills assessment, we should feel comfortable accessing and operating in a windows environment without access to a GUI. Using CLI to take care of administrative tasks can increase our workflow and allow us to spend more time working on the things that require more attention. What can we do next to continue our learning journey in the wide world of Windows?

What's Next?

Check out the [Setting Up](#) module to better understand how to configure and automate your own custom-built Windows hosts. Also, check out the [Introduction to Active Directory](#) module to get a feel for how AD environments work. As an admin and pentester, you will undoubtedly run into Active Directory over and over again wherever you are, as it's a standard for directory services in many organizations' environments.

More Windows Learning Opportunities

The Hack The Box main platform has many targets for learning and practicing against Windows hosts. The [Beginner Track](#) on the main HTB platform is an excellent resource for practice. [Tracks](#) are curated lists of machines and challenges for users to work through and master a particular topic. The [Beginner Track](#) contains three easy-level Windows boxes to test your new command-line skills against. Even if you cannot solve these boxes alone, it is still worth working on them with a walkthrough or video to get a feeling for common Windows misconfigurations and attack paths. The more you expose yourself to these topics, the more comfortable and second nature CLI use will become. The boxes below are also great for practicing the skills learned in this module.

Starting Point

[Starting Point](#) is a great chance to start hacking Windows and Linux hosts in a guided fashion. The labs are great for those starting out with pentesting and do a great job explaining why you are doing the things you are. We highlight this so you can get a chance to practice your command-line kung fu in a challenge-based scenario, much like the main boxes released on the main platform.

Boxes to Pwn

- [Blue](#)
- [Support](#)
- [Return](#)

Ippsec has recorded videos explaining the paths through many of these boxes and more. As a resource, [Ippsec's site](#) is a great way to search for videos and write-ups pertaining to many different subjects. The search functionality can be used to find specific tools or action items like [powershell modules](#) or [*.bat](#), it's not just a video reference.

Great Videos to Check Out

[HTB Live Demo 0x13 - You Should Try Some \[Powercat\]\(#\) & \[Powercat\]\(#\) on Windows Hosts](#) - [Ippsec](#)



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- [PowerShell for Pentesting](#) was presented at INtelligence 2018 by Nick Douglas provides an interesting look at how you can take basic PowerShell tasks and weaponize them for Pentesting.
- [PowerShell & Under The Wire](#) John Hammond goes over a cool platform called UnderTheWire, where you can practice your PowerShell Kung-Fu.

The videos above can help provide you with great follow on training and references showing how powerful CLI usage on Windows is.

Writers and Blogs To Follow

Between the HTB [Discord](#), Forums, and [blogs](#), there are plenty of outstanding write-ups to help advance your skills. One to pay attention to would be [Oxdf's walkthroughs](#). These are also great resources to understand how CLI access can be used in the real world. [Oxdf](#) writes about much more, and his blog is a treasure trove of information and applicable skills, tips, and tricks. The list below contains links to other authors and blogs we feel do a great job discussing security topics, tool usage, and much more.

- [Microsofts Training Documentation](#) is an interesting and great resource for those looking for a deeper dive into Powershell usage.
- [Black Hills Information Security](#) writes quite a bit about PowerShell, Command Prompt usage, and exploitation, among other things. Their content is excellent, and they have a breadth of blog posts to absorb.
- [SANS](#) Has a great blog set that details the usage of many PowerShell and CMD components. As a bonus, this webcast on the use of [PowerShell in Pentesting](#) is worth the watch.

Closing Thoughts

Being proficient with different operating systems CLI's is a must for any aspiring pentester, sysadmin, and many other roles. When dealing with Windows environments, you will inevitably have to use PowerShell or CMD at some point. As a pentester, being able to import your own modules, reference, and take advantage of built-in tools to acquire information, elevate privileges, persist on a host, and live off the land, if you will, is an invaluable skill. Keep practicing your CLI usage, and you will be a master in no time.

Thanks for following along on this adventure, and keep on learning!

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+10 Streak pts

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- Managing Services
- Working With Scheduled Tasks



PowerShell

- CMD Vs. PowerShell
- All About Cmdlets and Modules
- User and Group Management
- Working with Files and Directories
- Finding & Filtering Content
- Working with Services
- Working with the Registry
- Working with the Windows Event Log
- Networking Management from The CLI
- Interacting with The Web
- PowerShell Scripting and Automation



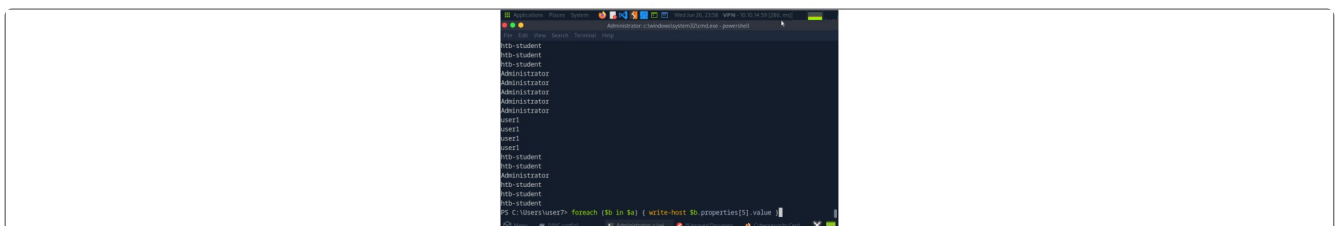
Finish Strong

- Skills Assessment



[Beyond This Module](#)

My Workstation



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[Terminate](#)

[Reset](#)

Life Left: 36m

